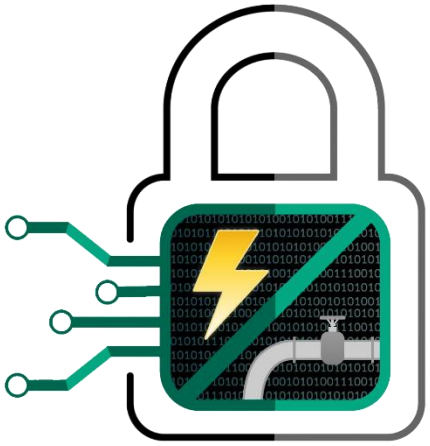


U.S. DEPARTMENT OF ENERGY'S

CYBERFORCE COMPETITION®

DEFENDING U.S. ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE

C-SUITE INFORMATION

2026

CYBERFORCE COMPETITION®

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KEY DATES

Monday, October 26, 2026	Students are provided with their C-Suite Scenario. Students are provided with instructions to log into the controller.
Tuesday, October 27, 2026 6:00pm CT (4:00pm PT)	C-Suite Fireside Chat *(optional & recorded)*
Monday, November 2, 2026 10:00am CT (8:00am PT)	C-Suite Panel video due
Monday, November 2, 2026	Students are provided with directions for accessing the rules. Students are provided with access to AWS.
Monday, November 2, 2026 6:00pm CT (4:00pm PT)	Rules Fireside Chat *(optional & recorded)*
Monday, November 9, 2026 10:00am CT (8:00am PT)	Security Documentation due
Friday, November 13, 2026 11:00am – 8:00pm CT @ Tinley Park Convention Center, Illinois	Students are provided with extended help support hours with competition staff to answer any final questions. Red team and Blue team mandatory check in
Saturday, November 14, 2026	Competition Day

KEY RULES

The C-Suite Panel is a pre-recorded video based on the task described below. Record your video and upload it to a platform accessible to judges in the name format of TeamXXXX, indicating your team number (e.g., Google Drive, YouTube, Vimeo, Streamable). YOUTUBE LINKS ARE PREFERRED.

Before submitting, test your link to ensure it works. Then, submit the link in a text file (.txt) to the scoreboard by **MONDAY, NOVEMBER 2, 2026, AT 8AM PST**. Judges will begin reviewing videos shortly after.

- **Accessibility requirement:** Your video must remain accessible from NOVEMBER 2–14, 2026.
- **AI usage:** While AI has allowed us to work smarter, this presentation should not utilize AI-generated text for your final submission. Any AI usage must be sited and sourced in your presentation.

C-SUITE PANEL

POINTS: 1000

The C-Suite Panel is a pre-recorded video based on the task provided below. This video should be recorded and placed somewhere accessible to judges. It can be Google Drive, YouTube, Vimeo, Streamable, etc. The preference is for you to submit a YouTube link. Please have other people test your link prior to submitting. Submit the link in a text file (.txt) for viewing to the scoreboard on or before **Monday, November 2, 2026, at 8 AM PST (10 AM CT)**. *This C-Suite needs to make a major decision for their company and will not be able to reschedule their meeting with you.* Judges will view your video shortly after. Your video must be accessible from Monday, November 2 – Saturday, November 14, 2026.

BACKGROUND

Vulcana Dynamics Ltd. (VDL) is the sole power utility responsible for electricity generation, transmission, and distribution across the Kaldera Archipelago. The company supplies electricity to civilian customers throughout the island chain and to the Island Defense Radar Network, the archipelago's only early-warning system. The two radar installations depend entirely on the VDL grid and have no secondary grid connection or backup generation.

Last night, the grid experienced an unexplained outage lasting approximately two minutes and thirty-six seconds. Electrical service has been restored, and the radar network is currently operational. However, the root cause of the technical outage remains uncertain, and conditions in the field indicate that the grid is still under stress. An initial review by the rapid response team identified the likely cause of the outage was a cyber incident.

But VDL's executive leadership cannot wait for a complete technical investigation before making operational decisions. Another disruption could affect the defense mission, civilian service, company operations, regulatory obligations, finances, and public confidence. At the same time, no additional funding is available during the contract period. VDL must respond by using its current personnel and capabilities, reprioritizing existing work, and using widely available resources.

VDL's technical teams cannot yet determine whether another outage will occur. However, modeling and field conditions indicate that if another major disruption occurs, VDL may not be able to maintain uninterrupted service to both the Island Defense Radar Network and all civilian customers.

BRIEFING FOCUS

You are advising the executive leadership team of Vulcana Dynamics Ltd. (VDL) during an emerging operational crisis. Your audience includes the Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Chief Operating Officer (COO), Chief Information Officer (CIO), Chief Financial Officer (CFO), Chief Communications Officer (CCO), and Chief of Staff.

These leaders are responsible for determining how VDL will maintain essential operations, protect the Island Defense Radar Network, continue providing electricity to civilian customers, manage business and reputational consequences, and allocate limited resources as conditions evolve.

Your role is to advise leadership, not to provide a technical incident-response briefing. The C-Suite does not need a detailed explanation of network architecture, vulnerabilities, or cybersecurity tools. They need to understand what is at risk, what decisions must be made, what tradeoffs those decisions create, and what VDL should do next. Focus on business consequences, operational priorities, executive decisions, resource tradeoffs, communications, and measurable results. Technical actions may be included when their business or operational value is clearly explained.

TASK

The executive leadership challenge: VDL may not be able to guarantee uninterrupted electricity to both the Island Defense Radar Network and all civilian customers if conditions worsen. Leadership must determine how to prioritize essential services, what operational or business impacts it is willing to accept, and how those decisions should be communicated to affected stakeholders.

Your team has been asked to give a five-minute presentation to the C-Suite answering their questions by Monday, November 2, 2026 at 10:00am CT:

1. If another major disruption occurs, what are the most significant consequences to VDL's mission and business?
2. If VDL cannot guarantee uninterrupted service to everyone, which should receive priority, the Island Defense Radar Network or civilian customers, and why? What risk is VDL accepting by making this choice?
3. What two or three actions should VDL take with its existing personnel, capabilities, and resources to prepare for and manage another disruption? How would leadership know when conditions have changed enough to adjust those actions or priorities?
    - For each action, explain:
        - What will VDL do?
        - What problem does it solve?
        - Who is responsible?
        - What will VDL have to delay, reduce, or stop to make this happen?
    - How would leadership know when conditions have changed enough to adjust those actions or priorities?
4. What should VDL communicate to its most important stakeholders, and what decision or commitment do you need from the C-Suite today?

Note: *There is no single correct answer. Your team will be evaluated on the quality of your reasoning, the tradeoffs you identify, and how well you defend your recommendation.*

C-SUITE PANEL BRIEF (VIDEO) RUBRIC

	0 - Not Present	1 – Emerging	2 – Developing	3-Proficient	4-Exemplary
Presentation Requirements (8%)	• Required elements are missing. • Video file has no sound, is corrupt, or unviewable by the scoring team.	• Video introduction does not include Team ID# • Video is significantly shorter or longer than 5 minutes. • Only one team member can be identified as a participant in any way.	• Video includes Team ID#. • Video is longer or shorter than ~5 minutes (less than 3 minutes or more than 7 minutes). • Only one team member is an active presenter. • Additional team members are acknowledged.	• Video includes Team ID#. • Video length is approximately 5 minutes but too long or too short for amount of relevant information provided. • Two equally active presenters are in the video. • Acknowledgement of contributions from some team members.	• Video includes Team ID#. • Video length is approximately 5 minutes, and all time is used well. • Two or more active team members participate equally. • Clear acknowledgment of contributions from all (either on- or off-screen) team members.
Risk Analysis and Mission Impact (20%)	• Risks and consequences are not discussed or are unrelated to the scenario.	• Identifies one risk or consequence, but discussion is vague, inaccurate, or not connected to VDL's mission or operations.	• Identifies at least two risks or consequences. • Provides limited discussion of how those risks or consequences could affect VDL mission and business objectives.	• Identifies two relevant risks and explains the potential impact on VDL's mission and business objectives. • Discussion demonstrates clear understanding of potential organizational impacts. • Presentation is not suitable for all members of the C-Suite (e.g., excessive jargon and technical details).	• Identifies at least three significant risks and explains their potential impact on VDL's mission and business. • Clearly distinguishes between the risk itself and the resulting consequence. • Uses business-focused language appropriate for executive leadership.
Service Prioritization & Tradeoff Decision (30%)	• No prioritization recommendation is provided.	• Recommendation for service priority is unclear, unsupported, or fails to recognize consequences of the decision.	• Makes a recommendation of service priority with limited justification. • Tradeoffs, consequences, or accepted risks of the selected approach are only partially addressed.	• Presents a clear service priority recommendation supported by logical reasoning. • Demonstrates understanding of benefits, drawbacks, and risks associated with the chosen approach.	• Presents a clear, defensible service priority recommendation supported by strong evidence and executive-level reasoning. • Explicitly identifies tradeoffs, accepted risks, affected stakeholders, and operational consequences. • Acknowledges uncertainty and explains circumstances that could justify changing priorities
Operational Action Plan (30%)	• No meaningful actions are proposed.	• Actions are unrealistic, unsupported, or require resources beyond those available in the scenario.	• Identifies one or more relevant actions. • Provides limited implementation details or weak connections to the problems being addressed. • Indicators or conditions provided for leadership to use to determine need for adjustment are difficult to measure.	• Recommends two or more realistic actions that use existing resources or add no addition cost. • Explains what VDL will do and the problem it solves. • Partially explains who is responsible and what will be delay, etc. to make it happen. • Establishes indicators or conditions that signal needed adjustment to leadership	• Recommends two or three well-prioritized actions that use existing resources and effectively address identified challenges. • Clearly explains what VDL will do, who is responsible, what problem is solved, and what organizational tradeoffs are required. • Establishes measurable indicators or conditions that leadership can use to determine when priorities or actions need adjustment.
Stakeholder Communications (12%)	• Stakeholder communication is not addressed.	• Communication recommendations are vague, incomplete, or fail to identify key stakeholders.	• Identifies some stakeholders and communication needs but messaging lacks clarity, purpose, or relevance.	• Identifies major stakeholder groups and recommends appropriate communications. • Clearly identifies the decision or commitment needed from leadership.	• Develops a clear stakeholder communication strategy that addresses expectations, trust, transparency, and organizational objectives. • Clearly articulates the specific decision, approval, commitment, or risk acceptance required from the C-Suite and explains why executive action is necessary.
Quality of Presentation (5%)	• Presentation does not follow scenario guidelines.	• Inappropriate dress code—team is not dressed for a work environment. • Many visual distractions. • Inappropriate visual aids, slides or other on-screen materials.	• Appropriate dress code—team is dressed for a work environment. • Few visual distractions. • Visual aids, slides or other materials lack professionalism.	• Appropriate dress code—team is dressed for a work environment. • Minimal visual distractions. • Visual aids, slides and other materials are acceptable.	• Appropriate dress code—team is dressed for a work environment. • Visual aids, slides and other materials have a consistent, professional appearance.